

ELO1

Subject Specific Pedagogy: ELL

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A fourth grader who arrived six weeks ago from another country points, nods, and follows directions but rarely speaks. The student loves art class and has two older siblings. What should the teacher conclude and do?

- A.** This is the normal preproduction stage; give comprehensible input and ways to respond without speaking, such as gestures.
- B.** Require spoken answers to push progress.
- C.** Treat it as a sign of a learning disability.
- D.** Refer the student for a speech-language evaluation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An English learner answers questions with one or two words, such as “yes” or “red book,” and understands much more than she can say. Which stage fits best?

- A.** Advanced fluency.
- B.** Early production.
- C.** Speech emergence.
- D.** Preproduction.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

An English learner in a class of 25 was laughed at after a mistake during a whole-class answer and now stays silent. The class sits in rows near the window. What should the teacher do?

- A.** Correct every error publicly so the student learns faster.
- B.** Assign extra grammar drills.
- C.** Continue as before, since anxiety never affects language learning.
- D.** Use low-risk practice, such as partner talk before whole-class sharing, and model errors as normal.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A teacher who recently earned an ESL endorsement plans a sheltered science lesson on states of matter. The lab has six sinks. Which is the language objective?

- A. Students will describe changes of state using sequence words such as first, next, and then.
- B. Students will complete the lab worksheet.
- C. Students will learn English.
- D. Students will identify three states of matter.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In a sheltered lesson on animal groups, which is the content objective?

- A. Students will use “because” to explain their classifications orally.
- B. Students will enjoy learning about animals.
- C. Students will classify animals as vertebrates or invertebrates.
- D. Students will sit with a partner during the sort.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

An intermediate-level English learner who excels in class discussions with manipulatives faces a unit math test full of long word problems. The test is printed on both sides of the page. How can the teacher assess the student’s math knowledge fairly?

- A. Replace the test with easier math problems.
- B. Exempt the student from the test.
- C. Use the test as is, since any accommodation is always unfair.
- D. Keep the same math but simplify wording and add visuals, a glossary, or a read-aloud.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A district that recently opened a STEM magnet school gives newly arrived English learners the same English-only textbooks and instruction as everyone else, with no language support, and calls this equal treatment. Which ruling does this practice conflict with most directly?

- A. None, because equal materials always mean equal opportunity.
- B. Plyler v. Doe.
- C. Brown v. Board of Education.
- D. Lau v. Nichols.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

What did Lau v. Nichols require of school districts?

- A.** Provide bilingual education in every district.
- B.** Enroll all children regardless of immigration status.
- C.** Take affirmative steps to overcome language barriers.
- D.** Teach English learners in English only.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A district's English-learner program, which serves students speaking 14 languages, is based on well-regarded research and is staffed with trained teachers. The district has never checked whether students gain English proficiency. Which Castañeda requirement is unmet?

- A.** Adequate implementation with resources and staff.
- B.** Evaluation showing the program is working.
- C.** Sound educational theory.
- D.** None; a research-based program always meets the test.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A program is based on sound theory and reviews results every year, but the district provides no trained teachers or materials for it. Which Castañeda requirement is unmet?

- A.** Adequate implementation with resources and staff.
- B.** Evaluation of results.
- C.** Sound educational theory.
- D.** None, because yearly review makes up for resources.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A new seventh grader enrolls in October; the home language survey shows Spanish is spoken at home. The student chats easily with classmates at lunch and plays on the soccer team. What is the next step?

- A.** Refer the student for special education.
- B.** Skip testing, since the student speaks English easily with friends.
- C.** Give an English language proficiency screener.
- D.** Place the student in ESL services right away.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

At a conference held in the school cafeteria, parents of a second-grade English learner ask whether they should stop reading to their child in Portuguese at home. The family moved here last year. What should the teacher advise?

- A.** It makes no difference which language they use.
- B.** Keep reading in Portuguese; literacy skills built in the home language transfer to English.
- C.** Stop, because Portuguese will interfere with learning English.
- D.** Speak only English at home from now on.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A fourth grader who arrived six weeks ago from another country points, nods, and follows directions but rarely speaks. ~~The student loves art class and has two older siblings.~~ What should the teacher conclude and do?

Target word: interpret the behavior **Decides:** Early listening without speech fits the silent period.

A	Correct	The silent period is expected; responses through action build comprehension.
B	Inverted operation	Forcing speech raises anxiety and does not speed acquisition.
C	Confusion set	Confuses a language stage with a disability.
D	Adjacent category	Normal language development is not a speech disorder.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

An English learner answers questions with one or two words, such as “yes” or “red book,” and understands much more than she can say. Which stage fits best?

Target word: name the stage **Decides:** Short one- to two-word responses.

A	Adjacent category	Advanced fluency is near-native use.
B	Correct	One- or two-word answers mark early production.
C	Confusion set	Speech emergence uses simple full sentences.
D	Inverted operation	Preproduction has little or no speech.

3. Answer D Concept 2

An English learner ~~in a class of 25~~ was laughed at after a mistake during a whole-class answer and now stays silent. ~~The class sits in rows near the window.~~ What should the teacher do?

Target word: lower the affective filter **Decides:** Anxiety is blocking participation.

A	Inverted operation	Raises the affective filter further.
B	Adjacent category	Does not address the anxiety.
C	Absolute language	Anxiety does affect acquisition.
D	Correct	Lowers anxiety so input can become acquisition.

4. Answer A Concept 3

A teacher ~~who recently earned an ESL endorsement~~ plans a sheltered science lesson on states of matter. ~~The lab has six sinks.~~ Which is the language objective?

Target word: identify a language objective **Decides:** It names the language students will use.

A	Correct	Names a language function and forms.
B	Dropped element	An activity, not an objective.
C	Adjacent category	Too broad to guide one lesson.
D	Confusion set	That is a content objective.

5. Answer C Concept 3 • transfer

In a sheltered lesson on animal groups, which is the content objective?

Target word: identify a content objective **Decides:** It names the science students will learn.

A	Confusion set	That is a language objective.
B	Adjacent category	An attitude, not content.
C	Correct	Names the concept being learned.
D	Inverted operation	A grouping arrangement, not a learning outcome.

6. Answer D Concept 4

An intermediate-level English learner who excels in class discussions with manipulatives faces a unit math test full of long word problems. ~~The test is printed on both sides of the page.~~ How can the teacher assess the student's math knowledge fairly?

Target word: valid content assessment **Decides:** Reduce language barriers without changing the math.

A	Adjacent category	Lowers the content standard, a modification.
B	Dropped element	No evidence of learning is gathered.
C	Absolute language	Accommodations support valid measurement.
D	Correct	Linguistic accommodations separate math skill from reading load.

7. Answer D Concept 5

A district ~~that recently opened a STEM magnet school~~ gives newly arrived English learners the same English-only textbooks and instruction as everyone else, with no language support, and calls this equal treatment. Which ruling does this practice conflict with most directly?

Target word: legal precedent **Decides:** Identical materials without support deny meaningful access.

A	Absolute language	That is the reasoning Lau rejected.
B	Confusion set	Plyler addressed undocumented children's right to attend school.
C	Adjacent category	Brown addressed racial segregation.
D	Correct	Lau held that the same materials are not equal opportunity for students who cannot understand them.

8. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

What did Lau v. Nichols require of school districts?

Target word: the holding **Decides:** Affirmative steps, without a set method.

A	Confusion set	Lau did not require a specific program model.
B	Adjacent category	That is Plyler v. Doe.
C	Correct	Lau required action but left the method open.
D	Inverted operation	Lau found English-only without support inadequate.

9. Answer B Concept 6

A district's English-learner program, ~~which serves students speaking 14 languages~~, is based on well-regarded research and is staffed with trained teachers. The district has never checked whether students gain English proficiency. Which Castañeda requirement is unmet?

Target word: missing prong **Decides:** No evaluation of results.

A	Adjacent category	Trained teachers meet this prong.
B	Correct	The third prong requires evidence of results.
C	Confusion set	The research base meets this prong.
D	Absolute language	All three prongs are required.

10. Answer A Concept 6 • transfer

A program is based on sound theory and reviews results every year, but the district provides no trained teachers or materials for it. Which Castañeda requirement is unmet?

Target word: missing prong **Decides:** No resources or staff.

A	Correct	A program on paper must be carried out with real resources.
B	Confusion set	Results are reviewed yearly.
C	Inverted operation	The theory is in place.
D	Absolute language	Each prong must be met on its own.

11. Answer C Concept 7

A new seventh grader enrolls in October; the home language survey shows Spanish is spoken at home. The student chats easily with classmates at lunch ~~and plays on the soccer team~~. What is the next step?

Target word: identification step **Decides:** The survey flags; a screener decides.

A	Adjacent category	Nothing suggests a disability.
B	Confusion set	Social language (BICS) differs from academic language (CALP).
C	Correct	The screener determines whether the student qualifies for services.
D	Dropped element	Skips the screener; the survey only flags.

12. Answer B Concept 8

At a conference ~~held in the school cafeteria~~, parents of a second-grade English learner ask whether they should stop reading to their child in Portuguese at home. ~~The family moved here last year~~. What should the teacher advise?

Target word: home-language guidance **Decides:** First-language literacy transfers to English.

A	Confusion set	Rich home-language literacy does make a difference.
B	Correct	Common underlying proficiency supports both languages.
C	Inverted operation	Home-language literacy supports English literacy.
D	Absolute language	Cutting off the home language loses a strong foundation.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	10	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	10	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	0	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Stages of second language acquisition	Learners typically move from preproduction (a silent period of listening) to early production (one- or two-word answers), speech emergence, intermediate, and advanced fluency.	Treating the silent period as a disability or forcing speech too early.	A description of what a newcomer can say or do.
2	The affective filter	Anxiety and low confidence block the use of comprehensible input, so low-risk practice supports acquisition.	Correcting every error in public to “speed up” learning.	An anxious or embarrassed English learner.
3	Content and language objectives	Sheltered lessons pair a content objective (what students will learn) with a language objective (the language function, forms, or vocabulary students will use).	Writing a second content objective and calling it a language objective.	“Which is the language objective?”
4	Assess content separately from language	Linguistic accommodations (plain language, glossaries, visuals, read-aloud) let English learners show content knowledge without lowering the content standard.	Exempting the student, or lowering the content expectation.	A content test with heavy English demands.
5	Lau v. Nichols (1974)	Giving English learners the same materials and teachers without language support is not equal educational opportunity; districts must take affirmative steps.	Thinking identical treatment is equal treatment, or that Lau required one specific program.	Newcomers given the same English-only materials with no support.
6	Castañeda v. Pickard’s three-part test	An English-learner program must be based on sound theory, implemented with adequate resources and trained staff, and evaluated to show it works.	Assuming a research-based design alone meets the test.	A program description missing one element.
7	Identifying English learners	A home language survey flags possible English learners; an English language proficiency screener decides eligibility.	Placing a student from the survey alone, or skipping the screener because the student chats easily.	A newly enrolled student and “what comes next?”
8	First-language literacy transfers	Literacy skills and concepts learned in the first language transfer to the second (common underlying proficiency), so families should keep building home-language literacy.	Telling families to stop using the home language.	A family asks whether to keep reading in their home language.

Course scope (public description): Subject Specific Pedagogy: ELL integrates aspects of pedagogy, assessment, and professionalism in English Language Learning (ELL). A student develops and assesses aspects of language curriculum development including second language instruction, methods of second language assessment, and legal policy issues.